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TRUMP ANNOUNCES 10-DAY ISRAEL-LEBANON CEASEFIRE



Lebanese army soldiers secure the site of an Israeli drone attack that targeted a vehicle on the highway of Saadiyat, south of Beirut, yesterday. US President Donald Trump announced a 10-day ceasefire between Israel and Lebanon, set to begin at 2am GST today, as US-backed negotiations gained momentum following direct talks in Washington. **SEE ALSO P13**

UAE pupils back to campuses on Monday

No school bus services for now as contingency plans in place

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

Several UAE students across nurseries, schools and universities are expected to return to campus from Monday with the authorities announcing a full return to in-person learning late on Wednesday night.

Fresh developments yesterday added a twist, with the Ministry of Education announcing the postponement of school bus services, leaving families to arrange their own travel.

The move led several private schools to continue distance learning, at least temporarily, citing logistical challenges and approvals.

Hybrid/flexible models

At the same time, universities are set to resume on-campus classes, with many planning hybrid or flexible models depending on operational readiness.

Addressing parental concerns online, the Ministry said student safety remains paramount and that schools must comply with strict reopening protocols. It also reassured families that contingency plans are in place and that institutions are prepared to adapt if needed.

“School transport services require additional operational

coordination with relevant authorities, including transport bodies and municipalities, to ensure readiness in line with the highest safety standards,” the Ministry said.

It clarified the decision will be reviewed weekly, while fees for bus services in private schools will be handled by local education authorities in line with regulations. It also stressed that schools must show flexibility on a case-by-case basis for families facing transport challenges.

Meanwhile, schools have begun surveying parents on their preferred mode of learning. In Sharjah, at least one school has made in-person learning compulsory for students using own transport.

SEE ALSO P2, 11

UAE labour market stable, wages on time

MOHRE SAYS THERE'S NO IMPACT ON JOB STABILITY AMID REGIONAL CRISIS

DUBAI
BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

The UAE's labour market continues to demonstrate resilience and stability despite ongoing regional developments, with businesses operating smoothly and workers receiving wages on time, according to the Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratization (MoHRE).

In a statement issued yesterday, MoHRE confirmed that the country's private sector remains unaffected by regional uncertainties, underlining the strength, diversity and sustainability of the UAE economy.

The Ministry highlighted that business continuity is being maintained across sectors, supported by strong collaboration between the government and private sector. This stability is reflected in data from the Wage Protection System (WPS), which shows that companies continue to meet their obligations by paying workers' salaries on time.

High compliance levels

MoHRE noted that compliance levels among private sector establishments remain high, reinforcing confidence in the country's economic outlook and the effectiveness of government policies designed to ensure uninterrupted operations. The UAE's advanced legislative framework

More than 2.3 million customer transactions were completed in March alone, bringing the total for the first quarter of 2026 to approximately 7 million.

and digital infrastructure have also enabled flexibility in work arrangements, helping businesses adapt to changing conditions. Most businesses, however, continue to operate from their usual workplaces.

The Ministry added that it continues to monitor wage payments in coordination with the UAE Central Bank, with the WPS covering around 99 per cent of private sector workers. Compliance rates have remained consistent, with no significant changes observed.

Operational indicators further highlight the sector's stability. More than 2.3 million customer transactions were completed in March alone, bringing the total for the first quarter of 2026 to approximately 7 million. Meanwhile, MoHRE's call centres handled over 4 million interactions, and 1.5 million consultations were delivered in 22 languages through legal consultation centres, reflecting strong service delivery and preparedness.

SEE ALSO P5, 6, 7, 11

BUSINESS

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US-ISRAEL-IRAN WAR

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